



Audio Sound Decision

Deciding the right speaker system for you might prove a tricky task. Let us help you make the right choice—one that would be music to your ears and your pocket

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Have you always wanted to experience sound that is superlatively clear, that gives you a theatre-like immersive experience, without trooping to the theatre or spending a fortune? Then a speaker set for your PC might be the answer for you. Your computer is not merely a tool for speeding up your work. C'mon admit it, you do listen to the latest numbers, play *Quake*, and watch action flicks on your computer. So don't you think you deserve the best sound system at a price you can afford? So take your pick from a range of speakers—from the conventional two-speaker stereo models, to speakers that offer you the Dolby Digital/Pro Logic decoder.

Overview

Almost all high-quality musical programmes, be it music, movies or games available today are either recorded in

stereo or recorded on more than two channels and mixed down to stereo for distribution on compact disks. Given that the object of a high-end audio playback system is to reproduce the original performance as closely as possible, it is obvious that providing surround capability would further that goal.

In a live performance, sound arrives from all directions, creating a sense of envelopment and clueing the audience into the unique acoustics of the performance space. Stereo playback can only offer a thin slice of these qualities. The difference signal between the left and right channels can be used to recover ambience information from stereo recordings. This L-R signal, often called the surround signal, is also used to drive a pair of speakers located behind the listening area. For home audio systems this type of environment can be created only by using a DVD player that

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